

Every year, the Zero1 Awards issue answers a very simple question: what is the fastest, most capable tech you can actually buy right now in India. Not the most hyped, not the nicest looking, not the best marketed, simply the best performing hardware in its class. From phones and laptops to TVs, graphics cards and SSDs, the Zero1 Awards is the platform where we line up the year's heavy hitters and let the numbers decide who walks away with a trophy.

Over the last twelve months, that list has grown more diverse than ever. On the mobile side, you will find everything from budget workhorses and mid-range all-rounders to camera monsters, gaming phones, foldables and the new wave of AI centric smartphones. Laptops have split into focused tribes: no compromise gaming rigs, more attainable gaming machines, creator workhorses, premium thin and light models and mainstream notebooks that are built for everyday life first and benchmarks second. Audio has its own spread, covering Bluetooth speakers, wireless headphones and truly wireless earphones across multiple price bands, because the best choice for a commuter is rarely the same as the best choice for a studio desk.

Beyond the obvious personal devices, there is a lot of core hardware that quietly defines how all of this feels to use. Desktop processors, NVMe SSDs, external SSDs and graphics cards are tested to the same standard as they would be for the most demanding builds in the Digit Test Lab. Wearables and TVs are treated just as seriously: smartwatches in the price no bar segment, OLED and mini LED televisions, along with gaming monitors that need to please both competitive players and cinematic purists. The aim is to map out the performance landscape across the stack, from the screen you stare at to the silicon that keeps everything running.

CATEGORIES

■ Premium Flagship Phone.....	54	■ Creator Laptops	71
■ Foldable Phone.....	55	■ Bluetooth Speaker	72
■ High-End Phone (₹35–50K)	56	■ Wireless Headphones	73
■ Mid-Range Phone (₹20–35K).....	57	■ Premium Truly Wireless Earphones	74
■ Budget Phone (Under ₹20,000)	60	■ Mid-range Truly Wireless Earphones	75
■ Camera Phones.....	61	■ Budget Truly Wireless Earphones	76
■ AI Smartphones.....	62	■ Smartphone SoC.....	77
■ Battery Phone	63	■ Desktop processors.....	78
■ Gaming Smartphone	64	■ Graphics Cards	79
■ Tablets	65	■ Internal SSDs.....	80
■ Gaming laptops (₹250K+).....	66	■ External SSDs	81
■ Gaming laptops (₹151K–250K).....	67	■ Smartwatch.....	82
■ Gaming laptops (₹60K–150K).....	68	■ OLED TVs	83
■ Premium, Thin and Light laptops	69	■ Mini LED TVs	84
■ Mainstream Laptops	70		

Zero1 Awards themselves are deliberately brutal. The Zero1 winner in each category is the product that performs the best in our tests, without any consideration of price, aesthetics or brand familiarity. If it tops the charts, it gets the trophy, even if the sticker shock is painful. The Best Buy Award looks at the same test data from the opposite direction, crowning the product that delivers the strongest performance per rupee while still clearing our bar for quality and usability. Together, the two awards answer both sides of the question most readers actually have: "What is the fastest thing I can buy?" and "What should I realistically spend my money on?"

To get there, every product you see in these pages has been through the same structured, repeatable test process that underpins our regular reviews. Phones are pushed through camera, display, battery, performance and gaming suites. Laptops are hammered with productivity, content creation and long gaming sessions. PC components are stressed with synthetic and real world workloads until we are sure we have seen their best and worst behaviour. TVs, audio gear and monitors are measured with instruments where appropriate and judged against demanding usage scenarios rather than short showroom demos.

If you are hunting for the absolute best gaming laptop, the most capable flagship phone, the strongest graphics card or the most sensible SSD upgrade, the Zero1 Awards is meant to be your guide. Every product here has earned its spot by surviving a year's worth of launches and comparisons. The margins between winners and close contenders can be razor-thin, which is why you will often see a strong runner-up mentioned alongside the Zero1 and Best Buy picks. Use the following pages as a map for your next big purchase, or simply as a snapshot of what state-of-the-art looks like today before the next cycle of hardware tries to beat it next year. **d**